**Endangered (EN)**

A taxon is Endangered when the best available evidence indicates that it meets any of the criteria A to E for Endangered, and it is therefore considered to be facing a very high risk of extinction in the wild. Example: *Elaeocarpus venustus, Pogostemon nilagricus, Eugenia singampattiana.*

**Vulnerable (VU)**

A taxon is Vulnerable when the best available evidence indicates that it meets any other criteria A to E for Vulnerable, and it is therefore considered to be facing a high risk of extinction in the wild. Example: *Dalbergia latifolia, Santalum album, Chloroxylon sweitenia*

**Near threatened (NT)**

A taxon is Near Threatened when it has been evaluated against the criteria but does not qualify for Critically Endangered, Endangered or Vulnerable now, but is close to qualifying for or is likely to qualify for threatened category in the near future.

**Least concerned (LC)**

A taxon is Least Concerned when it has been evaluated against the criteria and does not qualify for Critically Endangered, Endangered, Vulnerable or Near Threatened, Widespread and abundant taxa are included in this category.

**Data deficient (DD)**

A taxon is Data Deficient when there is inadequate information to make a direct, or indirect, assessment of the risk of extinction based on its distribution and/or population status.

**Not evaluated (NE)**

A taxon is Not Evaluated when it has not yet been evaluated against the criteria.

P9U9QT

## 8.7.2 Endemic Centres and Endemic Plants

Endemic species are plants and animals that exist only in one geographic region. Species can be endemic to large or small areas of the earth. Some are endemic to a particular continent, some to a part of a continent and others to a single island.

Any species found restricted to a specified geographical area is referred to as ENDEMIC.. It may be due to various reasons such as isolation, interspecific interactions, seeds dispersal problems, site specificity and many other environmental and ecological problems. There are 3 Megacentres of endemism and 27 microendemic centres in India. Approximately one third of Indian flora have been identified as endemic and found restricted and distributed in three major phytogeographical regions of india, that is Indian Himalayas, Peninsular India and Andaman nicobar islands. Peninsular India, especially Western Ghats has high concentration of endemic plants. *Hardwickia binata* and *Bentinckia condapanna* are good examples for endemic plants. A large percentage of Endemic species are herbs and belong to families such as Poaceae. Apiaceae, Asteraceae and Orchidaceae.

| Endemic plants | Habit | Name of endemic centre |
|---|---|---|
| *Baccaurea courtallensis* | Tree | Southern Western Ghats |
| *Agasthiyamalaia pauciflora* | Tree | Peninsular india |
| *Hardwickia binata* | Tree | Peninsular and northern India |
| *Bentinckia condappana* | Tree | Western ghats of Tamil Nadu and kerala |
| *Nepenthes khasiyana* | Liana | Khasi hills, Meghalaya |

**Table 1:** Endemic plants

Majority of endemic species are threatened due to their narrow specific habitat, reduced seed production, low dispersal rate, less viable nature and human intereferences.. Serious efforts need to be undertaken for their conservation, otherwise these species may become globally extinct.



TN_GOVT_BOTANY_XII_PAGES_191-211 CH 08.indd 189 3/8/2020 2:55:13 PM